

Question:

A 50 years old patient presented to the skin OPD with erythematous scaly plaques over trunk and extremities for last 10 years. Lesions are occasionally itchy. There is history of remission and relapse with exacerbation during winters. Most likely diagnosis is?

Answer Choices:

- A. Lichen planus
- B. Psoriasis vulgaris
- C. Pityriasis rosea
- D. Seborrhic dermatitis

Reasoning + Answer:

Let's analyze the clinical scenario step-by-step :

1 . ** Age and Duration of Symptoms : **

- The patient is 50 years old , which is within the typical age range for psoriasis .
- The lesions have been present for 10 years , indicating a chronic condition .

2 . ** Clinical Presentation : **

- Erythematous scaly plaques over the trunk and extremities suggest a chronic inflammatory skin condition .
- The lesions are occasionally itchy , which is a common symptom in psoriasis .
- The history of remission and relapse , especially with exacerbation during winters , is characteristic of psoriasis . Psoriasis often worsens in cold weather and improves in warmer months .

3 . ** Differential Diagnosis : **

- ** Lichen Planus : ** Typically presents with polygonal , flat-topped papules , pruritus , and is more common in women . It does not usually have a winter exacerbation .
- ** Psoriasis Vulgaris : ** Characterized by well-defined , erythematous , scaly plaques that tend to be worse in winter and better in summer . It fits the clinical presentation and history .
- ** Pityriasis Rosea : ** Usually presents with a herald patch followed by smaller , oval , scaly lesions . It does not typically have a chronic course or winter exacerbation .
- ** Seborrhic Dermatitis : ** Characterized by greasy , scaly patches , commonly on the scalp , face , and upper chest . It does not fit the widespread distribution over the trunk and extremities .

4 . ** Conclusion : **

- The chronic nature of the condition , the typical distribution of erythematous , scaly plaques , and the exacerbation during winters strongly suggest psoriasis .

<think>

- The patient's symptoms fit the clinical presentation of psoriasis vulgaris .
- The chronicity , distribution , and seasonal exacerbation are consistent with psoriasis .
- Other conditions like lichen planus , pityriasis rosea , and seborrhic dermatitis do not match the clinical presentation as closely .

</think>

<answer>

B . Psoriasis vulgaris

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